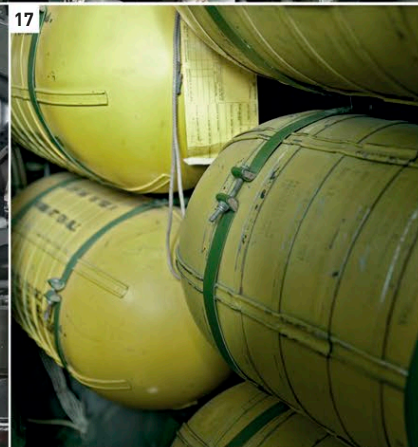
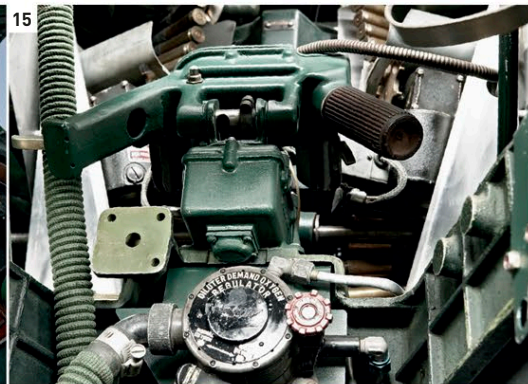
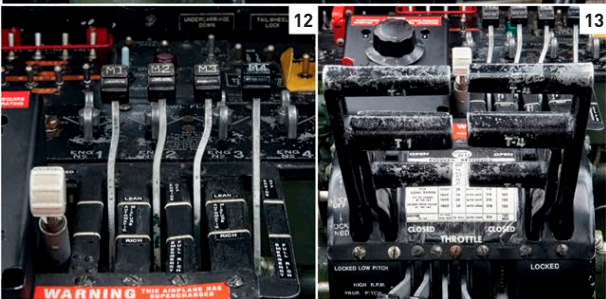
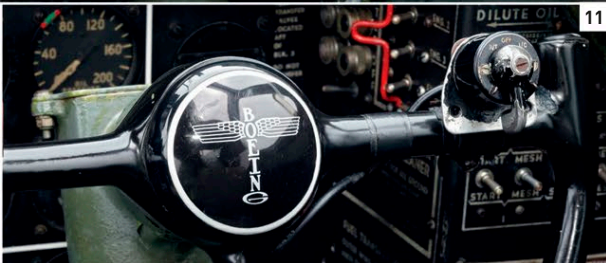




THE INTERIOR

Packed with bombs and fuel, the B-17 offered only limited space for the crew. The bombardier and navigator had to crouch to reach their seats in the nose of the bomber. The pilot and copilot sat on the flight deck, with the flight engineer above and behind them. The radio operator's station was the only place where a crew member could stand fully upright. The ball-turret gunner had to be small to be able to fit into his notoriously cramped station beneath the fuselage and the tail gunner had to crawl through the rear of the fuselage to reach his remote position.

14. Bombardier's seat and Norden bombsight in nose compartment 15. Upper turret controls 16. Forward fuselage interior 17. Oxygen bottles 18. Sophisticated waist-gun sight 19. Bomb bay—typically carried 6,000 lb (2,722 kg) of bombs 20. Rear gunner's station in the tail